BUSINESS & ECONOMY | Challenges

HATE, HUBRIS, AND HARD STATISTICS:
Debating hard statistics

GLASS HALF EMPTY OR HALF FULL?

Data and statistics are normally used to reinforce a fact. However, as the political discourse in the country becomes more intense, parties of all hues support their arguments with facts and figures that sometimes seem to look discordant. This can be very confusing, and can raise doubts on the real state of the Indian economy. In this session, the two panelists were asked by the moderator to demystify a few sets of numbers regarding economic growth, inflation, digitalisation and so on, where there are diverging views from political parties. There was an obvious discord. Former finance minister P. Chidambaram refuted the growth numbers saying that the economy is "losing steam" as is evident in the quarterly numbers. However, Neelkanth Mishra, a member of the PM's Economic Advisory Council, said quarterly numbers can be misleading, and came up with data to show India is indeed a bright spot amid the gloom across global

P. CHIDAMBARAM
Former Union Minister of Finance and Home Affairs

There is no boast in saying 'I am the one-eyed monarch of the blind'. When China grows at 3 or 3.5 per cent, it will still add to its annual wealth every year, several times more than India growing at 7 per cent

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You are looking at the newly constructed bridge and saying, 'What a beautiful bridge!' But you are not seeing those who huddle under the bridge



Photographs by HARDIK CHHABRA